

Bring out the Popcorn!

Let your senses reel. Set up surround sound on your PC for under Rs 10,000 for that immersive home theatre experience

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The screen fills with the image of the cars lined up at the start line. A heavy silence hangs in the air, only to be shattered suddenly by a shrill whistle and the screech of tires as the cars zip down the street, going from zero to 100 kmph in less than 5 seconds. Your hand freezes on its way to the popcorn bag and the hair rises at the back of your neck as the room reverberates with the sound coming at you from different directions.

No, you are not sitting in a movie theatre with Dolby Digital sound. You are lounging in a chair in your room, with your feet propped up on the desk, watching *The Fast and the Furious*...on your PC! Surprised? Don't be. It's easy to set up a home theatre system on your PC. The most critical component of a home theatre system is surround sound and you can set that up for less than Rs 10,000.

Even if you are not a movie buff, a killer sound system on your PC could give you that extra edge in games by allowing you to hear an enemy sneaking up behind you or simply rendering crystal clear MP3 playback with all the finer nuances audible.

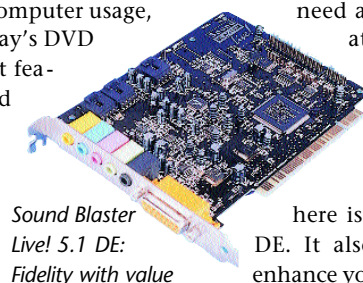
What do you need?

Most PCs only come with stereo support in their audio system and though this is sufficient for general computer usage, the entire effect of today's DVD movies and games that feature surround sound audio tracks would be lost in a conventional stereo setup. Therefore, you would need to add some form of surround sound

equipment to your PC. Each of these components plays a very specific role in bringing you an overall surround sound experience.

Multi-channel soundcard: The majority of soundcards today can handle only two channels of sound (stereo). However, to experience surround sound, the audio should come at you from all directions, not just in front of you. Therefore, at its most basic level you would need a soundcard that can output at least four channels of audio—two front channels (left and right) and two rear channels (left and right).

The soundcard of choice here is the Sound Blaster Live! 5.1 DE. It also features EAX which will enhance your gaming experience as well. With its proven audio performance, this



Sound Blaster Live! 5.1 DE: Fidelity with value